

MENTAL HEALTH ADVANCE DIRECTIVE

Combined Mental Health Declaration and Power of Attorney

Commonwealth of Pennsylvania · Act 194 of 2004 · 20 Pa.C.S. §§ 5801–5845

Part I — Principal (the person making this directive)

Full legal name: Margaret Eleanor Whitfield
Also known as: Maggie Whitfield
Date of birth: March 14, 1979 **Sex:** Female
Home address: 1428 Sycamore Lane, Apt 3B, Harrisburg, PA 17102
County: Dauphin **Telephone:** (717) 555-0182
Email: maggie.whitfield@example.com

Part II — When this Directive Takes Effect

This directive becomes effective when, and only when, my attending physician and one other qualified professional (a second physician or a licensed psychologist) examine me and determine in writing that I am *incapable* of making my own mental health care decisions. It stops being effective when they determine my capacity has returned.

- ☒ Two professionals must agree I lack capacity
☐ A court has found me incapacitated
☐ I have been involuntarily committed

Part III — My Mental Health Care Agent (Power of Attorney)

Primary Agent

Name	David Whitfield
Relationship	Brother
Cell phone	(717) 555-0199
Home phone	(717) 555-0143
Address	22 Linden Court, Camp Hill, PA 17011

Alternate Agent (if my primary agent is unavailable)

Name	Sarah Chen
Relationship	Close friend

Cell phone	(215) 555-0176
Address	88 Maple Avenue, Philadelphia, PA 19103

I authorize my agent to make mental health care decisions for me consistent with the preferences below. My agent may admit me to a facility for up to the period allowed by law and may consent to or refuse the treatments I describe in this document.

Part IV — My Treatment Preferences (Declaration)

Diagnoses

- Bipolar I disorder
- Generalized anxiety disorder

Allergies & adverse reactions

Substance	Reaction	Severity
Penicillin	Anaphylaxis — throat swelling	SEVERE
Lithium	Severe tremors, confusion (adverse reaction)	Moderate

Medications I PREFER

- Lamotrigine (Lamictal), 200 mg daily — has stabilized my mood well for years.
- Quetiapine (Seroquel), 50 mg at night — helps me sleep during episodes.

Medications I DO NOT want (unless I am in immediate danger)

- Haloperidol (Haldol) — caused severe dystonia (muscle locking) in 2019.
- Lithium — adverse reaction (see allergies).

Electroconvulsive Therapy (ECT)

☒ I **refuse** ECT and do not consent to it under any circumstances.

Experimental treatments

No experimental or investigational treatments without the express consent of my agent.

Preferred treating professionals & facilities

Preferred psychiatrist: Dr. Anita Rao, (717) 555-0120

Preferred facility: Pennsylvania Psychiatric Institute, Harrisburg

Facility to avoid: Riverside Behavioral (negative past experience)

Hospital & environment preferences

- I prefer a **private room**. If I must share, I prefer a **female** roommate.
- Please give me space rather than physical restraint. Restraint escalates my panic.

- Calm instrumental music and dim lighting help me settle.

De-escalation & crisis support

- What helps: quiet, being allowed to walk, calling my brother David.
- Warning signs I'm becoming unwell: not sleeping for two or more nights, very rapid speech, impulsive spending.
- Please notify my agent (David) as soon as I am admitted.

Part V — Other Instructions

- Emergency contact: David Whitfield (brother), (717) 555-0199.
- I have a cat, Juniper, who needs feeding — please tell David so he can care for her.
- I do not wish to be visited by my former partner, Greg Lawson.

Part VI — Signatures

I am at least 18 years old and of sound mind. I sign this directive voluntarily.

Principal signature: Margaret E. Whitfield **Date:** January 15, 2026

Witnesses

We witnessed the principal sign this directive. We are 18+ and are not the principal's agent, alternate agent, mental health provider, or an employee of the principal's treatment facility.

Witness	Signature	Date
Robert Klein 19 Oak St, Harrisburg, PA	Robert Klein	Jan 15, 2026
Patricia Gomez 4 Elm Ct, Camp Hill, PA	Patricia Gomez	Jan 15, 2026

This directive is valid for two years from the date of execution unless revoked sooner, or unless I am incapable of making mental health decisions when it would expire — in which case it remains in effect until my capacity returns. Questions: PA Protection & Advocacy, 1-800-692-7443.